Divide the class into two groups. Allot the roles for reading aloud. Start reading Scene - 1, followed by Scene - 2. To enact, follow the stage directions given in brackets.

Characters

Amy Marshall	- 17 years old
Betty Marshall	- her younger sister
Rose Field	- 16 years old, the Marshall's neighbour
Sara Field	- 9 years old, Rose's sister
Jim Hall	- 17 years old, another neighbour
Mr. Peters	- member of the Red Cross Disaster Committee
Penny Marsh	- Red Cross nurse

Time : *Late afternoon in March*
Setting: *Living room of the Marshall home*

Scene - 1

At Rise

Amy, Betty and Rose are sitting around the living room table. Amy and Rose are knitting. *Betty is looking at pictures in a magazine. The stage is not very bright.*

Rose :

Goodness, it gets dark early on these rainy days. Mind if I raise the shade a bit, Amy?

Amy :

No, do, but I guess we need the light on, too. *(She goes over and puts on the electric light.)*

Rose :

(Going to the window) How it rains! In sheets, and look! Your backyard is a small lake.

Amy :

*(*Joining Rose at the window*)* Gracious! I've never seen it rain so hard and this is the third day of it.

Betty :

(Puts down magazine and runs to the window) Whee..ee! It's more than a lake, it's a sea! The radio said the river was above flood stage this morning– whatever that means.

Amy :

It means that the water is above that white line on the bank at Thompson Bridge. It must have covered the south meadows and the highway there.

Rose :

It isn't only the rain. It's the snow melting in the hills in the northern part of the state. *(The girls return to the table.)* Oh, I hope we don't have a flood here! *(There is a noise of* stamping *feet and someone breathing hard. The girls all look to the right, the direction of the sounds.)*

Jim Hall :

(Entering from right in shining wet rain coat and rain helmet, which he drags off as he enters. He is panting.) Gosh, girls, it's a cloudburst! *(He kicks off his shoes.)* I've run every step of the way from school to get here. The river is rising fast. The Burnett Dam gave way an hour ago they say and it looks bad! Where is your mother, Amy?

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